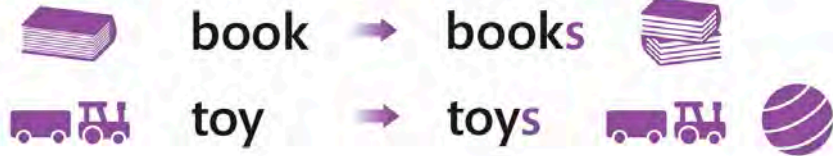


69.3 SPELLING RULES FOR PLURALS

To make most nouns plural, "-s" is added to the singular noun.



IRREGULAR PLURALS

For nouns ending in "-s," "-x," "-z," "-ch," and "-sh," "-es" is added.

watch
↓
watches

brush
↓
brushes

box
↓
boxes

bus
↓
buses

quiz
↓
quizzes

When a word ends in a singular "-z," the "z" is doubled and "-es" added.

For nouns ending in a consonant followed by a "-y," the "-y" is dropped and "-ies" is added.

dictionary
↓
dictionaries

story
↓
stories

For nouns ending in "-o," the plural is usually formed by adding "-es." If the noun ends in vowel plus "-o," the plural is formed by adding "-s."

echo
↓
echoes

radio
↓
radios

"Man" and "woman," and words made from them, such as in job names, have irregular plural forms.

man
↓
men

woman
↓
women

businessman
↓
businessmen

businesswoman
↓
businesswomen

Some other nouns have completely irregular plurals. A good dictionary can be used to check these.

child
↓
children

person
↓
people

Some nouns do not change in the plural.

species
↓
species

sheep
↓
sheep